COMMUNICATION IN THE WORKPLACE

CONTENTS

Communication and Workplace

Types of Communication

Tips for Effective Communication

Benefits of Effective Communication

COMMUNICATION

Exchange of ideas, feelings, and information by speaking, writing, symbolically, or by behaviour.

The art and technique of using words effectively to impart information or ideas.

Acceptable communication differs from company to company, but many aspects are universal.

"Communication is not about speaking what we think. Communication is about ensuring others hear what we mean."

- Simon Sinek

WORKPLACE

Physical, concrete thing, that is tangible, and holds people, relationships, and goals.

Workplace communication involves speaking, listening, and observing, plus the ability to understand verbal and nonverbal meanings in the communication process.

"To effectively communicate, we must realize that we are all different in the way we perceive the world and use this understanding as a guide to our communication with others."

– Tony Robbins

WHY COMMUNICATION?

Communication is an indispensable part of business success. It increases employee engagement, enhances client relationships, and improves the overall effectiveness of the team.

According to a research by Gartner, which is an American technological research and consulting firm, over 70% of business mistakes arise due to poor communication.

Communication in the workplace is the source of a ripple effect that streamlines business processes, enriches employee satisfaction, and positively influences the bottom line of business.

"The way you communicate reveals everything about you. Words are the clothes your thoughts wear."

– Amanda Patterson

TYPES OF COMMUNICATION AT WORKPLACE

Formal

- Communication through officially designated channels of message flow.
- Official information exchange.
- Found in organizational charts, policy manuals, hierarchical structures.

Informal

- Episodes of interaction that don't reflect officially designated channels of communication.
- Inherent, necessary aspect of organization life.
- Creates a relaxed, comfortable environment.

TYPES OF COMMUNICATION AT WORKPLACE

One-on-One

- Direct and personalized interaction between two individuals in the workplace.
- Typically a supervisor or manager and an employee, or two colleagues.
- Eliminates distractions, ensures messages are tailored to the specific recipient.

Digital

- Communication through digital technology.
- Emails, instant messaging, video conferencing, digital file sharing, online project management.
- Facilitates remote work, flexible work arrangements.

TYPES OF COMMUNICATION AT WORKPLACE

Downward

Flows from higher levels of authority to lower levels.

Managers or executives to employees or subordinates.

As information moves downward, it grows increasingly detailed.

Upward

Flows from lower levels to higher levels of authority.

Employee to supervisor, supervisor to department head, and so on.

As information moves upward, it becomes less detailed and more abstract.

TYPES OF COMMUNICATION AT WORKPLACE

Lateral

- Communication flow at the same organisational level.
- Back and forth communication between peers.
- No superior/subordinate relationship – it's simply teamwork.

Grapevine

- Filling the gap – a communication channel no one owns and no one controls.
- Informal and unofficial communication – arises due to a lack of confirmed information.
- Rumours, gossip, unverified information.

TIPS FOR EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Intention

- Ask yourself – why am I starting this project, why am I going to this meeting, why am I speaking to a particular person?
- Helps you to be more conscious and purposeful of what you're doing or saying.
- Ask others of their intentions.

Listen

- Listen to others attentively.
- Fosters a deeper, more positive connection with others.
- Poor listening leads to misunderstandings, miscommunications.

HOW GOOD OF A LISTENER ARE YOU?

A well-liked college teacher had just completed making up the final examinations, and had turned off the lights in the office. Just then a tall, dark, and broad figure appeared and demanded the examination. The professor opened the drawer. Everything in the drawer was picked up, and the individual ran down the corridor. The Dean was notified immediately.

LISTEN CAREFULLY!

ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

1. The thief was tall, dark, and broad.
2. The professor turned off the lights.
3. A tall figure demanded the examination.
4. The examination was picked up by someone.
5. The examination was picked up by the professor.

TRUE OR FALSE?

ANSWER THE QUESTIONS

6. A tall, dark figure appeared after the professor turned off the lights in the office.
7. The man who opened the drawer was the professor.
8. The professor ran down the corridor.
9. The drawer was never actually opened.
10. In this report, three persons are referred to.

TRUE OR FALSE?

ANSWERS

1. True
2. True
3. True
4. True
5. False
6. False
7. True
8. False
9. False
10. True

8 to 10	• Active listener
5 to 7	• Average
Below 5	• Need to be more attentive

HOW GOOD OF A LISTENER ARE YOU?

TIPS FOR EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Speak Clearly

- Cut out "ums", "uh-hmms", "ahhs".
- Keep your voice steady – don't talk too quickly or too quietly.
- Be confident in what you're saying.

Earn Respect, not Laughs!

- Showcase your skills and strengths to earn the trust and respect of your colleagues and superiors.
- Charisma is good, but only as icing on the cake.
- Laughter without prior substance is destined for doom.

TIPS FOR EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Posture and Eye Contact

- Posture tells a lot about you and your thoughts.
- First impressions matter, and having a good posture gives the impression of confidence and composure.
- Eye contact activates the limbic mirror system – automatic mimicry.

Know your Audience

- *Who* you are talking to is as important as *what* you are talking about.
- Different audiences require different ways of communication.
- Connect with your audience to persuade them.

BENEFITS OF EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Builds Trust

- Develops good relationships.
- Builds loyalty in a supportive climate.
- A trusting work environment is a successful work environment.

Promotes Teamwork

- Leaders who communicate thoughtfully make team members feel valued.
- Results in higher job satisfaction, better performance, and increased loyalty.

BENEFITS OF EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Inspired Solutions

- Peers who communicate effectively can build on each other's ideas.
- Can unleash creativity within yourself and others, leading to innovation.

Improves Teamwork

- Good communication is the backbone of team building and strong cross-functional bonds.
- One goal, one target that the whole team works towards in the most efficient manner.

BENEFITS OF EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Handle Conflicts Better

- Disagreements occur due to miscommunication, individuals not being heard.
- Give everyone the chance to speak – prevent conflicts and misunderstandings.

Empathy

- Why do people feel or act the way they do?
- Personal and professional relationships are boosted through a greater understanding of the people around us and their points of view.

THANK YOU

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